

Digital Conduct and Media Engagement Policy

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Applicable to Azim Premji University, Bengaluru, Bhopal and Ranchi Campuses

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1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 Social media and other digital communication platforms play an important role in how students communicate, learn and collaborate with one another, the University and with the wider society.

1.2 While these platforms create valuable opportunities for learning, sharing and community engagement, they also carry responsibilities. Content shared online can have lasting consequences for individuals, communities, and institutions, and may affect privacy, safety, reputation, and academic integrity.

1.3 This policy outlines expectations regarding safe and responsible usage of social media and other digital communication platforms by students of Azim Premji University and is designed to promote respectful engagement, protect privacy, prevent misuse and safeguard the interests of students, the University and its members.

1.4 For the purpose of this policy, "social media" includes social networking sites, content-sharing platforms, blogs, online forums, messaging applications, and other digital

communication channels that enable users to create, share, comment on, or distribute content. This includes but is not limited to Instagram, X, LinkedIn, Facebook, Telegram, Reddit, YouTube and Whatsapp.

1.5 This policy also applies to all University provided digital communication tools, including University email accounts, Moodle discussion forums and any other platforms made available by the University for academic, administrative or communication purposes.

1.6 **Media Enquiries:** Please note that the University has an authorised spokesperson for any media enquiry. Students who are approached by members of the media regarding University-related matters must refer such enquiries to the University's designated spokesperson, Sudheesh Venkatesh (sudheesh.venkatesh@azimpremjifoundation.org).

Unless expressly authorised by University authorities in writing, students must not represent themselves as speaking on behalf of the University in response to media enquiries. If students need information or resolution to any concerns, please reach out to the relevant team mentioned on RO website.

2. General Principles For Responsible Social Media Usage

2.1 Students are expected to exercise good judgement and act responsibly when using social media and other digital communication platforms.

2.2 Communicate respectfully: Treat others online with the same respect and consideration as expected in face-to-face interactions.

2.3 Exercise caution before posting: Consider the potential impact, including possible physical, emotional, or reputational harm to yourself, others, and the University, before posting, sharing, commenting on, or forwarding content. . If in doubt about whether a post is appropriate, it is best not to share it.

2.4 Be discreet: Exercise care when sharing personal information online, including photographs and location information relating to yourself or others, and respect the privacy and consent of others at all times.

2.5 Assume permanence: Most social platforms are public, and content can remain accessible long after being deleted—even in private or closed groups.

2.6 Protect your digital footprint: Consider carefully decisions to post content, follow others, or allow access to personal content. Online activity can shape long-term personal and professional reputation, including with future employers.

2.7 Be accountable: Do not post unverified information from others. The responsibility of ensuring the veracity of what you post, say and share lies with you.

2.8 Use appropriate channels: For addressing University-related concerns, seek accurate information and pursue clarification through the appropriate University channels rather than resorting to social media.

In addition to observing the general principles outlined above, students are required to comply with the following provisions governing the use of social media and other digital communication platforms.

3. Privacy and Consent

3.1 Students shall respect the privacy and dignity of others when using social media and other digital communication platforms.

3.2 Students shall not post or share photographs, videos, messages, recordings, personal information, or other content belonging to another student or member of the University without their consent.

3.3 Unauthorised circulation or publication of classroom interactions, meetings, guest lectures, University events, inquiry proceedings or other restricted interactions on social media platforms is a major violation of the Code of Conduct.¹

3.4 If a student is photographed or recorded by the University or fellow students for potential external publication, they have the right to withhold consent for public use.

4. Information Sharing and Responsibility

4.1 Students shall publish and share content that has been verified or approved by the designated authority. If not sure about the veracity of the content, it should not be shared.

4.2 Students shall not knowingly create, share, or circulate false or misleading information about other students, University members, or the institution itself.

4.3. Students are responsible for the content they create, share, forward, endorse, represent, or distribute online and cannot disclaim responsibility once it has been shared or circulated, irrespective of its source, and such content remains subject to the University's Code of Conduct.

5. Social Media Accounts Of Authorised Student Clubs

5.1 University-approved student clubs and groups may create and operate social media accounts to support their activities and engagement. Such accounts must be used responsibly and in a manner consistent with the University's values and policies. All content shared through club accounts must receive prior approval from the designated Club Mentor.

5.2 Official club platforms shall be used only for communication relating to approved activities, events, announcements, promotions, collaborations, achievements, or other authorised institutional purposes.

¹ Refer to section 4.7.8. of the Code of Conduct for Students, 2026

5.3 Personal opinions, political views, interpersonal disputes, anonymous allegations, or private grievances must not be communicated through official club platforms.

5.4 The University reserves the right to require removal of content or suspend access to any official club or associated platform found to be in violation of University policies or directives.

6. Unauthorised Representation of the University

6.1 Students shall not create or operate any unauthorised social media page, handle or other digital property using the university or related institution's name, acronym, or institutional identity in a manner that may create an impression that such platform is official or affiliated with the University.

6.2 Students shall not use the university's name, logo, acronym, branding, or any other element of its institutional or related organisations' identity to represent, speak on behalf of, or claim affiliation with the university on any digital platforms without prior authorisation.

6.3 Students shall not share or publish content that falsely suggests endorsement, sponsorship, approval, or representation by the University.

6.4 Any violation of the above will be considered a major violation under the University Code of Conduct.²

7. Classroom and Academic Content

7.1 Material discussed or shared in class — such as lecture recordings, presentations/ documents/ videos, guest sessions, or forums — is intended solely for students and faculty. Students shall not record, copy, or distribute such content to external individuals or post it on public platforms without prior written permission from the instructor and Programme Coordinator.

7.2 Moodle and other learning management systems used by the University are not public platforms; all content shared on these spaces is private and intended solely for classmates and faculty. Students shall not record, copy, or share any material from these platforms with external individuals or on public forums.

8. Respectful and Safe Online Conduct

8.1 Students must not engage in harassment, bullying, or threatening behaviour: Includes use of abusive or demeaning language, online harassment, threats to individual safety, or sharing others' personal content (e.g. photographs, messages) without consent.

8.2 Students must not share inappropriate or harmful content: Posting material that is defamatory, offensive, hateful, threatening, retaliatory, sexually explicit, obscene, or likely to damage the reputation of other students, university members or the University.

² Refer to section 4.7.13. of the Code of Conduct for Students, 2026

8.3 Students must not engage in disruptive online conduct: Repeated posts or actions on social media that interfere with the academic engagement or safety of other students.

8.4 The University has zero tolerance for conduct prohibited under this section and by Indian law. Any violation will be considered a major violation under the University Code of Conduct.³

9. Use of University Provided Digital Communication Tools

9.1 University email accounts and other University-provided digital communication tools are intended primarily for academic and official University communication only.

9.2 Students must not use them to i) harass or intimidate others; ii) circulate spam, promotional material, chain messages, or unauthorised advertisements; iii) download software onto their personal devices; iv) register on social media platforms, or for non-academic activities; v) impersonate the University, its officers, departments, faculty, staff, or student bodies; vi) share confidential, sensitive, or restricted University information without authorisation; vii) share any content which violates Indian law.

10. Penalties

10.1 Failure to comply with this Policy constitutes a violation of the Code of Conduct and would result in disciplinary action. Any violations of laws of India will be dealt with in accordance with relevant laws and regulations.

10.2 The examples and prohibitions contained in this Policy are not exhaustive.

10.3 The University reserves the right to take appropriate action under the University's Code of Conduct in relation to other forms of online conduct that adversely affect members of the University community, the academic environment, or the legitimate interests of the University.

³ Refer to section 4.7.1 and 4.7.5 of the Code of Conduct for Students, 2026